

MODULE 3 ORIENTATION GUIDE

Integrating HRBA in Project Design

A simple guide to the analysis and planning steps before the practice screens.

Use this guide before Screen 5 and return to it whenever a practice task feels difficult.

It explains what to analyze, why it matters, how the outputs connect, and how to keep evidence safe.



How to use this guide

Read it once before the practice screens, then use it as a reference.

1

Read the method

Understand the project-design process before using the tools.

2

Connect to practice

Each slide prepares you for maps, checks, pathways, and design repair.

3

Return when needed

Use the guide when an analysis step feels new or complex.

4

Keep evidence safe

Use generalized and non-identifying information in your portfolio.

Main idea: Module 3 is not only about learning terms. It is a guided process for improving project design.

What integrating HRBA in project design means

A project team uses human rights standards and principles to guide design decisions from the beginning.

It is not:

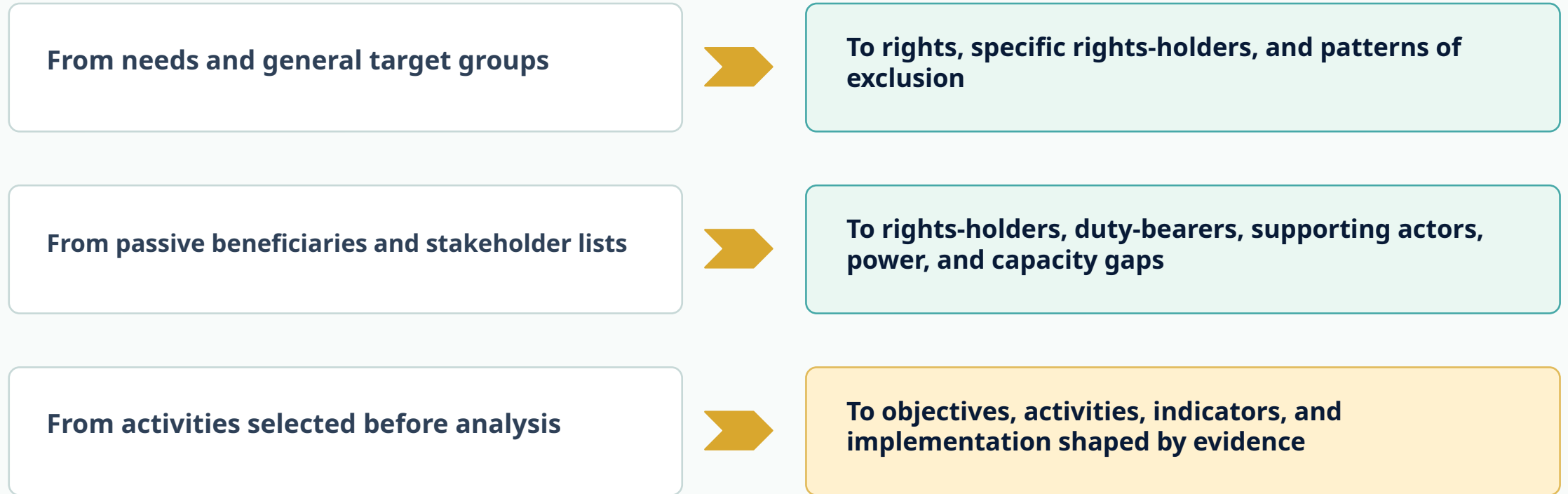
- adding human rights language after design is complete
- treating people only as service recipients
- making the CSO responsible for everything
- listing standards without changing project choices

It is:

- analyzing the local situation before finalizing activities
- identifying rights-holders, duty-bearers, barriers, causes, and risks
- using evidence to improve objectives, activities, indicators, and implementation
- building participation, accountability, and safe follow-up into the design

The design shift

HRBA changes how a project team moves from issue to design.



A finding is useful when it changes a decision, responsibility, activity, indicator, risk measure, or implementation arrangement.

The two-phase route

The module moves from diagnosis to design.

1. Analysis Phase

Understand the situation before finalizing activities.

- 1 Context and inequality**
Who is affected differently?
- 2 Standards and policy**
Which commitments and responsibilities apply?
- 3 Actors and capacity**
Who has responsibility and what gaps exist?
- 4 Causes, power, and risk**
What shapes the problem and what must be managed?



2. Planning Phase

Use the analysis to build a stronger project.

- 1 Intervention logic**
How do activities lead to intended change?
- 2 Inclusion and accountability**
How will people participate, give feedback, and receive response?
- 3 Objectives, activities, indicators**
What must be revised before implementation?
- 4 Review and watch-points**
What should be checked during implementation?

Principles become project-design checks

In Module 3, the principles are used as practical questions.

Participation

Can rights-holders influence decisions rather than only attend activities?

Accountability

Are information, feedback, response, explanation, and follow-up built into the design?

Non-discrimination and equality

Does the design respond to different experiences of exclusion?

Empowerment and capacity

Does the design strengthen rights-holders and duty-bearers?

Legality

Are choices connected to relevant standards, laws, policies, and service commitments?

The point is not to repeat the theory. The point is to use the principles to test and improve the project design.

Analysis Phase: purpose and outputs

The Analysis Phase establishes the evidence and reasoning for design.



The Analysis Phase examines the legal, institutional, social, cultural, geographic, and economic conditions connected to a project issue before activities are finalized. It helps the team avoid treating only visible symptoms and instead understand who is affected, why, and what must change.

Context and Inequality Scan
Policy and Standards Map
Rights-Holder and Barrier Map
Actor Responsibility Map
Power and Influence Map
Root-Cause and Capacity-Gap Map
Risk and Do-No-Harm Board

Main rule: analysis should inform all later project-design decisions.

Context and inequality analysis

Start by looking below the visible problem.

Purpose	Understand what is happening, who is affected differently, what barriers may exist, and what evidence should be checked safely.
Look for	Access, participation, information, mobility, livelihood, disability, gender, age, distance, service quality, and feedback barriers.
Output	A context scan that identifies design questions before activities, budgets, indicators, and participation arrangements are finalized.
Good practice	Use disaggregated and contextual evidence without recording names, complaints, exact locations, or sensitive details.



Policy and standards analysis

Connect the issue to rights, policies, strategies, service commitments, and responsibilities.



Why it matters

Standards and policies help explain what should be protected, provided, changed, or monitored.

What to connect

Human rights standards, national laws, sector strategies, service standards, local responsibilities, and project commitments.

How to use it

Use the reference to write a design question and a responsibility question.

What to avoid

Do not use references as decoration. They should guide project decisions.

Safe framing: use simple, constructive language that supports dialogue with local actors and clarifies responsibility.

Rights-holders, duty-bearers, and CSO roles

The analysis clarifies who holds rights, who has responsibilities, and how the CSO can support change.

Rights-holders

Specific people and groups entitled to claim and enjoy rights. Avoid vague categories such as “the community” when barriers differ.

Duty-bearers

Public institutions and actors with responsibilities to respect, protect, and fulfill rights. The project should not replace them.



Supporting actors

CSOs, community groups, service actors, committees, and others can facilitate dialogue, evidence, capacity support, and accountability.

CSO role

The CSO is usually an enabler: it supports participation, capacity, constructive engagement, and safe follow-up without taking over public duties.

Capacity-gap analysis

A service gap may have several causes, so the project should not assume the reason too early.

Mandate

Is the actor expected to act?

Knowledge

Do they know the standard, role, or process?

Skills

Can they carry out the task?

Resources

Are budget, staff, or tools available?

Coordination

Are responsibilities linked across actors?

Willingness and incentives

Are there reasons action is delayed or avoided?

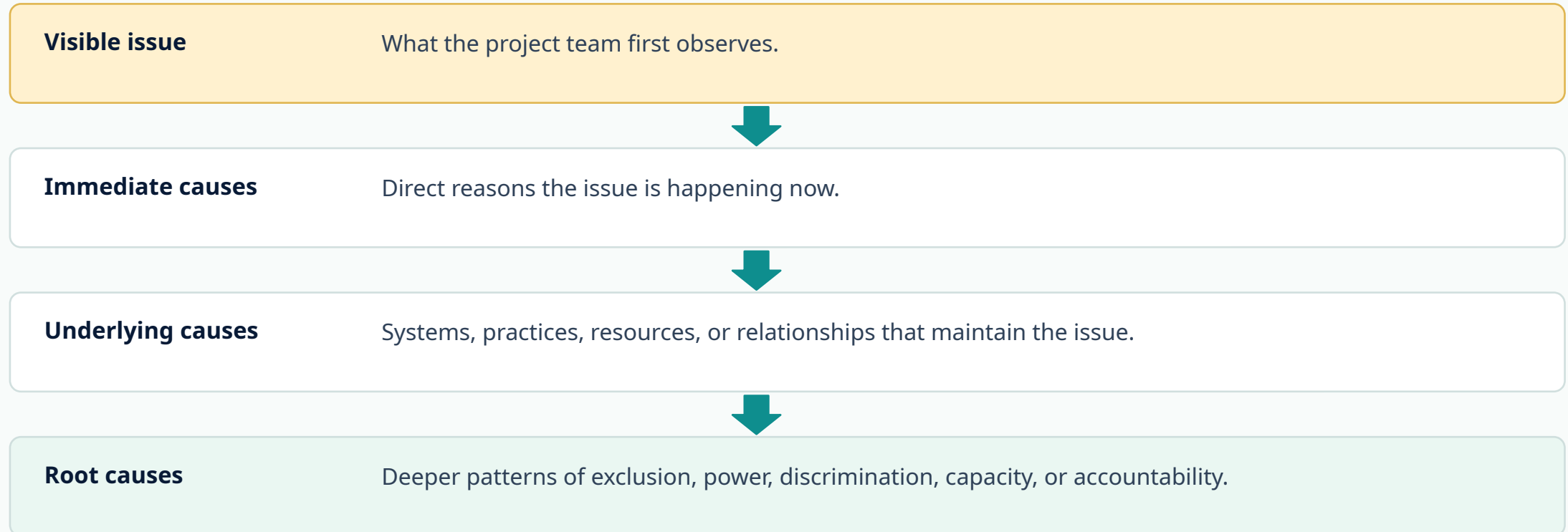
Accountability

Is there feedback, review, response, and follow-up?

Design implication: capacity gaps should shape activities, support measures, assumptions, indicators, and implementation watch-points.

Problem and root-cause analysis

A visible issue is only the starting point. The project must examine what drives it.



A strong project does not only respond to symptoms; it tests the causes that should change.

Power and influence analysis

Formal responsibility and practical influence are not always the same.



What to examine

Who controls information, priorities, resources, decisions, access, or follow-up?

Who can enable change?
Who may delay or block change?
Whose knowledge is not being heard?
Who needs stronger, safer voice?
What engagement approach is realistic?

What to avoid

Do not label people as enemies. Analyze roles, influence, incentives, risks, and safe engagement options.

Use power analysis to design engagement, not confrontation.

Risk, do-no-harm, and safe evidence

Analysis should protect people while still giving the project enough information to make good decisions.

Safe evidence pathway



Do not record

- real names or identifying details
- exact sensitive locations
- identifiable complaint details
- survivor stories or case narratives
- political accusations
- sensitive personal information

Use generalized, non-identifying summaries of patterns, barriers, roles, capacity gaps, evidence questions, and design implications.

Local knowledge and verified evidence

Local knowledge helps explain what standard data may miss.

What local knowledge can show

Timing, access, informal rules, communication channels, trust, service use, and whose voice is missing.

How to use it

Compare local observations with records, safe feedback summaries, accessibility checks, and project documents.

How to keep it safe

Use non-identifying summaries and avoid details that expose individuals or sensitive locations.

Local evidence should not stay as background. It should inform project decisions and watch-points.

Planning Phase: purpose and outputs

The Planning Phase converts the analysis into a structured project design.



Planning is where the findings become project choices. The objective, activities, intervention logic, indicators, evidence questions, participation methods, accountability arrangements, inclusion measures, assumptions, and risks should all reflect the analysis.

- Intervention logic
- Gender and disability integration
- Participation and accountability pathway
- Revised project objective and activity package
- Indicators and evidence questions
- Draft plan review and implementation watch-points

Intervention logic

Show how activities are expected to lead to outputs, outcomes, and change.



A rights-based intervention logic should make the pathway of change clear and testable.

Gender and disability integration

Inclusion should change design choices, not only appear in wording.

Check access

Can people reach, enter, understand, use, and influence project activities?

Check participation

Who needs preparation, accommodation, timing changes, safe channels, or support?

Check resources

Are budgets, responsibilities, materials, communication, and monitoring measures included?

Check feedback

Can people raise concerns safely and receive a response?



Mentioning women, youth, or persons with disabilities is not enough. The design must show the practical measures.

Participation and accountability in the plan

Participation means influence; accountability means response.

Information

What will be shared, when, in what format, and through which channels?

Participation

How will rights-holders influence priorities, activities, risks, and follow-up?

Feedback

How can people provide feedback safely and accessibly?

Response

Who reviews feedback, explains decisions, and documents what changed?

Follow-up

How will the project confirm whether the response reached the people affected?

Attendance is not the same as meaningful influence.

Indicators and evidence questions

Rights-based indicators should measure more than activities completed.

Weak indicator

Number of meetings held.

Stronger indicator

Percentage of agreed community priorities receiving a documented response from the responsible institution within the agreed period.

Weak indicator

Number of people trained.

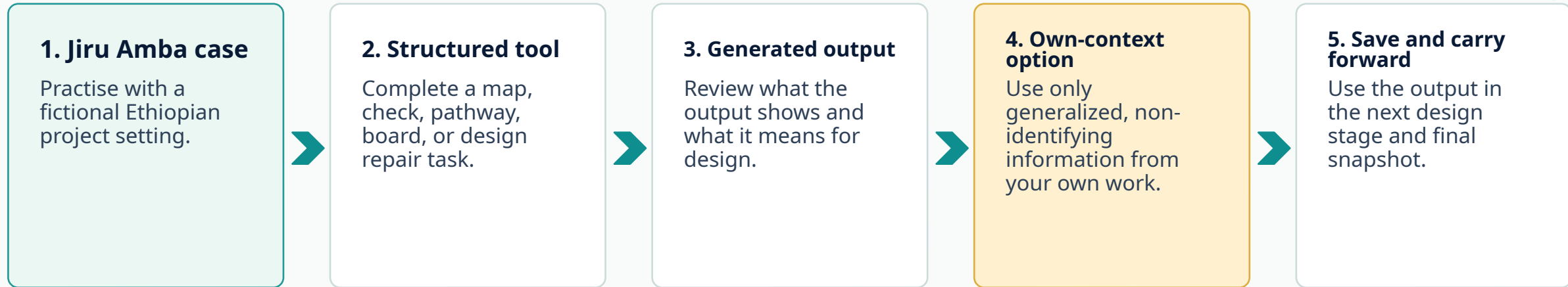
Stronger indicator

Percentage of trained duty-bearer staff who apply the agreed accessibility or feedback procedure during implementation.

Ask: Does this indicator show access, participation, accountability, capacity, inclusion, service quality, or change?

How you will practise in Module 3

The module uses Jiru Amba first, then optional generalized application to your own CSO work.



The case lets you practise the method before entering any real project details.

What you will produce

The outputs are connected. They build one project-design improvement snapshot.



Context and standards

Output informs later screens and the final snapshot.



Rights-holders and barriers

Output informs later screens and the final snapshot.



Responsibility, power, causes, capacity

Output informs later screens and the final snapshot.



Inclusion, participation, risk

Output informs later screens and the final snapshot.



Project-design repair

Output informs later screens and the final snapshot.



Review and snapshot

Final place to review, save, and prepare for implementation.

The snapshot is a draft learning and project-design product; it still needs organizational review before formal use.

Before you start the practice screens

Use this short checklist to confirm that the method is clear.



I understand that analysis should happen before activities are finalized.



I can distinguish rights-holders, duty-bearers, supporting actors, and CSO roles.



I know that context findings should carry forward into planning decisions.



I can explain why power, causes, capacity, risk, and accountability matter for design.



I will use generalized, non-identifying information for any own-context practice.



I know the final snapshot is a draft output for review and further development.

Selected resources used for this guide

Use these as reference materials when you want deeper reading.

Module 3: Integrating HRBA in Project Design V2

Core source for the analysis and planning phases, project-design shift, and practice flow.

Module 3: Ethiopian Grassroots Adaptation

Source for contextual application to local and grassroots CSO settings.

EU HRBA Toolbox

Reference for HRBA analysis, design questions, standards, participation, accountability, and risk.

Ethiopia HRBA Training Manual for Local CSOs

Reference for plain training style, HRBA principles, actors, and local application.

Updated HRBA Participant Manual

Reference for learner-facing HRBA explanations and practice support.

Return to this guide whenever the practice screens ask you to move from analysis to design decisions.